

Will Cygan

SENIOR SOFTWARE ENGINEER, LINKEDIN BUSINESS PLATFORM

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Work Experience

Senior Software Engineer

Chicago, IL

LINKEDIN

Mar 2024 – Present

- Led design of churn-recovery alerting platform driving \$2M+ annually by notifying subscribers of failed payments before cancellation; extended by 3 partner teams for Winback Offers, Usage Billing, and Mobile Billing (Venice KV read path sustaining 100K QPS peak from Feed; Kafka+Flink write path at ~500 msg/s on invoice-state changes).
- Designed Oracle-to-MySQL Delegation Framework (shadow reads, query perf comparison, phased migration, rollback) onboarded by all 10 LBP domain teams as the org-wide migration pattern; novel Couchbase-TTL entity-routing cutover ensured strong consistency with GoldenGate-caught-up safety guarantees.
- Led zero-downtime Oracle-to-MySQL migration of LinkedIn's Ordering Database (12TB / 20B rows / 6 tables) in partnership with DBAs running GoldenGate replication; rewrote 30,000+ lines of SQL/Java across ~75 PRs with JooQ/Flyway; zero data loss through 6-week phased ramp.
- Built distributed deletion pipeline (Airflow, Trino, Kafka, gRPC) that purged 300,000 corrupted order records in production with rate-limited writes; pipeline repurposed to target ~33% of the 10+ year-old Ordering database (~6B dormant OMS rows).
- Automated Venice TTL purging of 35+ day records on the Global Alerts cache, cutting cache size 40% and downstream Invoice Search API QPS 50%.
- Eliminated N+1 query problem in Order Processing system, reducing average query latency by 40% (50ms→30ms) and p95 by 37% (200ms→125ms) across all ordering workflow read paths.
- Designed Unified Optimistic Locking mechanism for the MySQL Ordering Database, eliminating a class of silent conflicting-write failures under Temporal activity retries via version-based concurrency control across every update-based write path.
- Delivered 5 agentic-development KT sessions reaching 1,000+ engineers using Claude Code; mentored 2 engineers on Global Alerts and MySQL Migration through design reviews and feature guidance, upleveling them and expanding team capability.

Software Engineer

San Francisco, CA

LINKEDIN

Feb 2022 – Mar 2024

- Scaled Videos You Might Be Interested In recommendation to 3,000 QPS on LinkedIn's 50M+ DAU Flagship Feed, driving +2.5% Weekly Skilled Learners (LinkedIn Learning's north-star metric) and +0.57% SWI on Skill Credits across 3 experiments.
- Built Learning Alerts V2 member/stage targeting framework from scratch, driving +1.09% WSL via Spark pipelines over 20+ datasets (~50TB/run) classifying 10M+ job seekers into career-change-funnel cohorts with deterministic bucketing for clean A/B readouts; ramped safely to 22M members.
- Improved LinkedIn Flagship Feed engagement +0.2% by filtering audio-only content from video course recommendations, a statistically significant lift at hundreds of millions of daily impressions.

Projects

Anton (Kubernetes Homelab)

github.com/wcygan/anton

- Built fault-tolerant 3-node bare-metal Kubernetes cluster using Talos Linux with GitOps CI/CD automation, achieving 99.9% uptime over 12+ months.
- Deployed distributed data systems (TiDB, RedPanda, DragonflyDB, ScyllaDB, ClickHouse) to evaluate performance characteristics and operational trade-offs of modern database alternatives.

Skills

Tools Claude Code, Codex, Java, Rust, Python, SQL, Bash, TypeScript

Infrastructure Kafka, Flink, Temporal, gRPC, Spark, Airflow, Trino, Kubernetes, Docker

Databases MySQL, Redis, Couchbase, Oracle, DragonflyDB, Venice, HDFS, S3

Education

University of Illinois at Chicago

Chicago, IL

B.S. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

2021